- The population of India has increased by more than ***181 million*** during the decade 2001–2011.
- Decadal growth rate of the population (2001–2011) has been 17.64 per cent (**i.e. 1.76 % per year**); males 17.19 and females 18.12.
- 2001–2011 is the ***first decade*** (with the exception of 1911–1921) which has actually added lesser population compared to the previous decade.
- Uttar Pradesh (199.5 million) is the **most populous** State in the country followed by Maharashtra with 112 million.
- The percentage decadal growth rates of the six most populous States have ***declined*** during 2001–2011 compared to 1991–2001:
  - Uttar Pradesh (25.85% to 20.09%)
  - Maharashtra (22.73% to 15.99%)
  - Bihar (28.62% to 25.07%)
  - West Bengal (17.77 % to 13.93%)
  - Andhra Pradesh (14.59% to 11.10%)
  - Madhya Pradesh (24.26% to 20.30%)
- During 2001–2011, as many as 25 States/UTs with a share of about 85% of the country's population registered an annual growth rate of less than 2% as compared to, 15 States/UTs with a share of about 42% during the period 1991–2001.
- 15 States/UTs have grown by less than 1.5 per cent per annum during 2001–2011, while the number of such States/UTs was only 4 during the previous decade.
- The total number of children in the age-group 0–6 is 158.8 million (-5 million since 2001).
- Twenty States and Union Territories now have over one million children in the age group 0–6 years. On the other extreme, there are five States and Union Territories in the country that are yet to reach the one hundred thousand mark.
- Uttar Pradesh (29.7 million), Bihar (18.6 million), Maharashtra (12.8 million), Madhya Pradesh (10.5 million) and Rajasthan (10.5 million) constitute 52% children in the age group of 0–6 years.